Q. You are performing with your sons and grandsons for *IBTIDA–Ek Mehfil* on Nov. 15. How special is it for you?

To share the stage with my children and grandchildren is the greatest blessing of God Almighty. The nature of every human being comes out through their music. The way [my son] Amaan plays is very distinctive. He has created his own world and he sounds like Amaan Ali Bangash. His younger brother Ayaan has also created his own world.... Abeer and Zohaan have just begun their journey. All credit goes to their parents, Ayaan and Neema, for planning their day so that they get to practise sarod beyond studies.

Q. There has been a re-emergence of baithaks and mehfils that encourage live music. What do you think about them?

There used to be mehfils and baithaks in the olden days, which is why it makes me happy to see them. Intimate settings always inspire artists. We have performed for the Nobel Peace Prize ceremony, where 10,000 people were in the audience. Chamber concerts are a very special setting in western music as well.

Q. How do you want the world to look upon your legacy?

The legacy carries on with the blessings of God Almighty and the people of India who respected and encouraged my forefathers. Historically, the great musicians were patronised by the rajas and maharajas. Our forefathers were the court musicians of the Scindia Parivar of Gwalior. When their rule was over, the people of India respected, encouraged and accepted all the great musicians.

Q. How do you think music and art help connect the world?

India is like a beautiful bouquet of flowers. We have so many religions, traditions and ways of life, but we depend on each other. This dependency is our strength. As a musician, I feel we belong to every religion of the world because music is a precious gift of God.

—with ***Deepali Dhingra***

Rhythm Q+A *Divine*

Sarod grandmaster ***Ustad Amjad Ali Khan*** *is all set to perform with two generations of his family at the Safdarjung Tomb in Delhi*



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